

Bible

Old Testament
New Testament
Church History
Spiritual Formation





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Old Testament: Grades 7-12, New Testament: Grades 7-8, Church History: Grades 7-9, Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

About Old Testament: Grades 7-12

From 7th grade through high school, students read through the OT chronologically. For 2026-2027 they read 2 Samuel-I Kings, 1 & 2 Chronicles, Psalms and Proverbs (selections) and Ecclesiastes. 12th grade will also read Song of Solomon. With the aid of study Bible notes and selections from study helps such as the Old Testament Today or The Bible Project, this course allows students to meditate on Scripture and engage with the historical and cultural context of the Bible when it was written, as well as the way the OT continues to be relevant as God's word today.

About New Testament: Grades 7-8

Students read through the book of Acts over the year. Additional study helps assigned in the lesson plans provide background information and context to help students begin to dive deeper into the life, ministry, and message of the early church.

About Church History: Grades 7-9

Students read about important events and influential people from Church History using biographies and narrative-driven overviews of the time period. In this course, students delve into the 19th century and learn the stories of a variety of Christians.

About Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

Spiritual formation courses help students think more deeply about various topics in the Christian life such as prayer, studying the Bible, and other spiritual disciplines.



Placement & Combining Tips

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

Students in Grades 7-12 read the same passages of Scripture, but the lesson plans include a variety of discussion questions and extra study helps differentiated by grade to help students engage at various depths. This makes these lessons flexible for individual students and/or a multi-age context. Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the narratives and overarching story of the OT.

New Testament: Grades 7-8

Younger students in Grades 5-6 can be combined with older students if they have a good general understanding of the gospels. Ideal for HS students who are new to studying the Bible or unused to commentaries or discussions about cultural context or interpretive issues.

Church History: Grades 7-9

Can be combined with Grades 5-6.

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

Also appropriate for HS students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7-12	Old Testament: Grades 7-12 2 times/week 30 min 2 times/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition Old Testament Today NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture ESV Concise Study Bible
7-8	New Testament: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition ESV Concise Study Bible Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey
7-9	Church History: Grades 7-9 1 time/week 30 min	Spurgeon: A Biography Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words
7-8	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 1 time/week 30 min	Transformed by Truth This Changes Everything

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Bible: Grades 7-8				
Old Testament: Grades 7-12	New Testament: Grades 7-8	Old Testament: Grades 7-12	Church History: Grades 7-9	Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Bible: Grades 7-8

Old Testament: Grades 7-12



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



Old Testament Today



NIV Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible: Bringing to Life the Ancient World of Scripture



ESV Concise Study Bible

New Testament: Grades 7-8



The Student Bible Atlas, Revised Edition



ESV Concise Study Bible



Introducing the New Testament: A Historical, Literary, and Theological Survey

Church History: Grades 7-9



Spurgeon: A Biography



Renewal: The Church That Expands Outward



An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8



Transformed by Truth



This Changes Everything



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)
(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Bible: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 6: Bible\)](#)

New Testament: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Video overviews of Bible books from Bible Project](#)
- ∞ [Teaching the Bible with Dr. John Walton](#)

Church History: Grades 7-9

- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Bible: Grades 7-8

How To Teach



Prepare

Read the commentary to prepare.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. Ask students to give a summary of what they remember. (Full narration is not necessary.)



Introduce

Use a picture, a map, or an engaging question to prepare students to receive the story. You may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

Read aloud from the Bible.



Narrate

Have the students narrate.



Share

Optional: Share something interesting from your preparation that will help shed light on the story.



Discuss

Give students an opportunity to share their thoughts on the story and any connections made.



Term 1

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 1

Materials: Bible, Old Testament Today, notebook

→ INTRO (FOR GRADES 7-12)

This year you will be reading 2 Samuel, 1 Kings, 1 & 2 Chronicles, selections of Psalms, Proverbs, and Ecclesiastes. You will be reading the passages chronologically, or in the order of the events. "The goal of studying the Bible chronologically is not to replace the time-honored canonical arrangement, but instead to honor time as a setting in which the biblical record appeared. Readers who study the Bible this way will return to their traditional Bibles better equipped to read them. Acquiring a sense of the flow of the Bible's story will put flesh and blood on its message" (from Chronological Guide to the Bible).

1. Your ESV Concise Study Bible (Grades 7-8) or Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible (Grades 9-12) will have maps, articles, and notes to help you along the way. If you have a question about a specific verse, see if there is a note about that verse below the text.
2. Use your Student Bible Atlas or atlas in your Bible to locate places as needed.
3. We will also utilize Old Testament Today and the Bible Project website as a handbook for helping us understand the background information we need to be informed readers. Look up the chapter of the Bible book you are reading in OT Today for any interesting sections you have not read before. Similarly, do a search at the Bible Project Website for the book you are reading and see what interesting articles or videos they have available when you have time in a lesson.

→ VIEW

1. Throughout the year, you will watch short videos of Dr. John Walton, the co-author of OT Today. The videos were created specifically for Alveary students. We hope they help you understand the Bible better.
2. You will be reading selections from the Psalms throughout the year. Watch this video to learn more about the Psalms.

∞ Video Link: Overview of the Psalms

→ PRINT

You may want to print out the summary of the book to reference as you read selections from the Psalms.

∞ Image Link: Psalms Overview Poster

→ READ, NARRATE & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.367-370 "To understand what" - "individual and nation."
2. Psalms 79-82

The psalms are difficult to tie to a specific historical context. They are the worship songs of Israel and are intended to apply to the needs of all worshippers across time. Some psalms do have historical superscriptions that make it possible to associate them with specific events, but these make up only about 10% of all the psalms. Another criterion is to place the psalms ascribed to David (or Solomon or Moses) during the life of that person. A second criterion is to place Psalms according to their type (from the Chronological Guide to the Bible).

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Bible Project Overview of the Psalms

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

Intro to Acts

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

Note: Introducing the New Testament is a resource book that will be used over 5 years. As students get older, they will read more sections and



Term 1

interact with some of the more scholarly questions about the New Testament. Only small sections will be read this year, but feel free to read more.

→ INTRO

1. The book of Acts is actually "part two" of the Gospel of Luke, but it has been put in its own section in the New Testament (following the four Gospels) because it is the only book that relates the history of the early church—what happened after the events reported in the Gospels.

2. Watch this short video about Acts with the author of the book, Introducing the New Testament.

∞ Video Link: Acts

→ READ & NARRATE

Introducing the New Testament

1. p.205-206 "The book of" - "Lord Jesus Christ."

2. In the video, the author asked you to pay attention to the key motifs that are outlined in the book of Acts. A motif is a dominant idea or central theme. Read about a couple of the motifs or major themes in Acts:

p.216-220 "The book of" - "is worth remembering."

ESV Concise Study Bible

3. Although Luke is the author of two books in the New Testament, he is only mentioned three times in the Bible by name.

Read the following verses to meet the author of the book of Acts: Col. 4:14; 2 Timothy 4:11; Philemon 24; Luke 1:1-4; Acts 1:1-5; Luke 24:36-53

→ NOTEBOOK

You read about five of the major themes in Acts. Write down each theme on the top line of 5 different pages in your notebook. Then write a brief sentence of what that theme means. As you read through Acts this year, you will add the events that fall under the different themes.

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 2

📖 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ INTRO

Last year, we read through I Chronicles 16. Today, we will keep moving forward chronologically.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Davidic Covenant

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Read about 1-2 Chronicles p.223-224 in OT Today.

2. Psalm 83

3. I Chronicles 17

• EXTRA HELPING

Watch this summary of the whole OT in under 13 minutes.

∞ Video Link: OT Summary

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 1

William Wilberforce

📖 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

1. This year, we are learning about people who lived during the 19th century (1800-1900). We will read how these Christians lived out Jesus' commands. When Jesus was asked what the greatest command was, he replied, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind. This is the great and first

• IMPORTANT DATES

1759-1833 - William Wilberforce
1833 - Slave Trade was abolished in England

• DEFINITIONS

diminutive: (p.93) small size

• EXTRA HELPING

You can listen to the hymn Amazing Grace and follow along



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commandment. And a second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself." (Matthew 22:37-39)

2. Today, you will read about an Englishman named William Wilberforce (1759-1833) who was a member of Parliament, the lawmaking group in the government of Great Britain. Parliament consisted of two houses: the House of Lords and the House of Commons. The English had been part of the slave trade since 1662. In 1770, out of a total of one hundred thousand slaves a year from West Africa, British ships transported more than half. English considered the slave trade inseparably linked with the commerce and national security of Great Britain.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Painting of William Wilberforce

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.93-100 "The striking of" - "after this event."

- Wilberforce had considered withdrawing from public life for the sake of his faith. However, his pastor John Newton advised him, "It is hoped and believed that the Lord has raised you up for the good of his church and for the good of the nation." What do you think about that advice?

with the lyrics on p.100.

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace

WEEK 1 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 1

📖 Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ INTRO

How would you answer someone who asks why you study the Bible? As the title indicates, the first half of Transformed by Truth will focus on the why of studying the Bible, while the second half will move into the how of Bible study. As we move through the book's second half, we will apply the lessons to a chapter from your reading in the book of Acts.

→ READ & NARRATE

Intro p.13-16

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to reflect on the author's statement, "Teens need serious Bible study just as much as adults." Do you agree? Why or why not? What do you hope to learn about Bible study this year?

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 3

📖 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and I Chronicles last time?

→ VIEW

When you read the Bible chronologically, you switch back and forth between 1-2 Samuel, 1-2 Chronicles, and 1-2 Kings. Dr. Walton will explain what the differences are between those books, even though they are telling about the same time period.

∞ Video Link: Differences Between Two Accounts of Israelite History

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Read about 1-2 Samuel in OT Today p.204-208.
2. Psalm 88
3. 2 Samuel 8-9



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WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

Ascension

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 1:8 is the key verse of Acts, and the outline of Acts follows this verse as the gospel spreads and the church grows. Jesus gives the disciples a job after he leaves them on earth to ascend to heaven. "The ascension is the conclusion of the synoptic Gospels, and it is the introduction to Acts, where it begins the story of the development of the church" (Bible Story Handbook, Walton).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Introducing the New Testament p.220-223 "The Jewish matrix" - "of his name."

Read about 3 more major themes in Acts. (You can skip Box 10.5.)

2. ESV Concise Study Bible Acts 1:1-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the three additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation for each. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. For example, under the theme Centrality of Jerusalem, you can write: "Jesus orders his disciples not to leave Jerusalem."

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 4

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

- OT Today p.12-15 "A plotline traces" - "these three terms."
- ∞ Video Link: Big Ideas and Plotlines

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 10-11

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 2

Fact Files: The Beacons of Freedom and Justice

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

Give a brief account of what you remember about William Wilberforce.

→ INTRO

In this section, "The Beacons of Freedom and Justice," you will be introduced to four historical figures who were motivated by their Christian faith to help others find freedom and justice. The first person lived in the 1700's, so that is the century before the time period we are studying this year.

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

• IMPORTANT DATES

1733 - James Oglethorpe founded the colony of Georgia
1772 - John Newton pens Amazing Grace
1839 - Frederick Douglas becomes a licensed preacher
1850-1860 - Harriet Tubman's Underground Railroad Work

• EXTRA HELPING

Learn more about John Newton, the author of Amazing Grace
∞ Article Link: The Story of John Newton



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1. p.101-102 "Freedom is a word" - "should be applauded."
 2. Watch this video that tells about Oglethorpe's role in the founding of Georgia and then takes us up to the 19th century.
- ∞ Video Link: Founding of Georgia Colony

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.102-104 "Another Englishman who" - "Thee Are Spoken."
 2. p.104-107 "While men like" - "fight for themselves."
 3. Read this article to learn more about Harriet Tubman.
- ∞ Article Link: Black Moses

∞ **Video Link:** Newton's Grace: The True Story of Amazing Grace

WEEK 2 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 2

 Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.1 p.19-29

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more of the questions on p.29 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 5

 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.19-21 "Confidence in the Results" - "hermeneutics are insufficient."
2. ∞ Video Link: Defective Views of God

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. 2 Samuel 12
2. Psalm 51

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Pentecost

 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Acts 2 is considered the church's birthday. Luke shows how the Holy Spirit came upon all the believers there, and how they began speaking in other languages. This may bring to your mind the story from Genesis of the Tower of Babel. However, "[a]t the Tower of Babel, nobody could understand the languages, and it drove people apart. At Pentecost, the languages could be understood, and it brought people together into a unity that helped start the Church" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 2:1-41
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Study Bible.

- How does speaking different languages on the Day of Pentecost fit with



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the mission Jesus gave the disciples in Acts 1:8?

→ VIEW

🖼 Image Resource: Introducing the New Testament

Take a moment to look at the painting on p.211 (Fig. 10.1 Pentecost).

Describe what you see in the painting.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. There is not one right answer. You may want to refer to Introducing the New Testament for extra guidance.

WEEK 3 📅 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 6

🖼 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. Read OT Today p.9-12 "Most people come" - "the Old Testament."
2. ∞ Video Link: Tapestry Illustration

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 13

WEEK 3 📅 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 3

Emilie Mallet

🖼 Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

What do you remember about our last reading?

→ INTRO

Today, you will read about a French lady from the 1800s who may be unknown to you but has an interesting story of love and service to those in need. She could have just enjoyed her upper-class lifestyle but wanted to show the love of Christ to others.

→ VIEW

1. ∞ Image Link: Emilie Mallet
 2. The Pantheon in Paris (not to be confused with the Pantheon in Rome) is mentioned in this chapter. It is a mausoleum or monument that houses the remains of distinguished French citizens,
- ∞ Image Link: Pantheon in Paris

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.109-117 "The shrieks could" - "margins of society."
 2. Read these excerpts from the biography A Christian woman; being the life of Mme. Jules Mallet, translated by Mrs. H.N. Goodhart. Most of them are journal entries from Emilie about the circumstances in Paris.
- ∞ PDF Link: Excerpts from A Christian Woman

- What did you learn about Emilie from her journal entries?

→ VIEW

Have you seen Toile de Jouy fabric before? It is actually French for "cloth from Jouy." It was produced by Emilie's father and can still be found today on decorative fabrics and wallpaper.

∞ Image Link: Toile de Jouy

• DEFINITIONS

Cholera: (p.109) a disease that is caused by bacteria through water or food that has been tainted. Cholera can cause serious diarrhea and dehydration and can be fatal.

aristocracy: (p.111) upper class usually made up of a hereditary nobility

• IMPORTANT DATES

1832 - Emilie Mallet begins her charity work for young children and prisoners



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WEEK 3 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 3

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

Part of Bible study starts with basic questions, such as, "What does the Bible say about this matter?" Rather than taking an author's opinion or statement as truth when claiming the Bible supports it, verifying and reading what the Bible says on the subject is important. As you read through Transformed by Truth, look up the Scripture references that are included as time allows. Today, those verses are assigned as part of the reading.

→ READ, NARRATE & DISCUSS

p.31-36 "When I was" - "others. Praise God!"

Also read the verses in the passage: Jer. 1:1-2; Ezek. 1:3; 2 Pet. 1:20-21; 2 Pet. 3:15-16; 2 Tim. 3:16; 1 Cor. 7:40

- Did reading the verses from the source (the Bible) help clarify or support the author's claim?

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions.

WEEK 4 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 7

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.181-186 Pedestals and Role Models (Skip 182-183)
2. ∞ Video Link: Biblical Characters

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 14:1-15:12

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Unity

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The Holy Spirit came on the Day of Pentecost, and the Christians were united, which led to the expansion of the church in the early days.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Introducing the New Testament p.223-226 "As in the" - "to be offended."

Read about two more major themes in Acts. (Skip the boxes.)

2. ESV Concise Study Bible Acts 2:42-47; Acts 3:1-10
(Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.



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→ NOTEBOOK

Add the two additional themes you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 4 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 8

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Moralistic Lessons

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.373-374 Interior Psalms Book 1
2. 2 Samuel 15:13-37
3. Psalm 3
4. 2 Samuel 16

WEEK 4 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 4

Sojourner Truth

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

Note: We are skipping the chapter on Charles Spurgeon since we are reading a whole book about him starting in Term 2.

→ RECAP

Who did you read about last week?

→ INTRO

Isabella Baumfree was born a slave to a Dutch master in New York c.1797. At age 46 or 47, she had a vision of God telling her to "travel up an' down the land showin' the people their sins an' bein' a sign unto them." This she did, with a new name that defined her mission—Sojourner Truth. She never learned to read or write but boldly spread a message of freedom for Blacks and women, as you will read about in this chapter.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.127-133 "The crowd outside" - "that historic building."
 2. Read the excerpt "Her Escape" from her memoir p.41.
- ∞ Link: The Narrative of Sojourner Truth

→ VIEW

The bronze bust of abolitionist and women's rights advocate Sojourner Truth is the first sculpture to honor an African American woman in the United States Capitol.

∞ Image Link: Bronze bust of Sojourner Truth

• IMPORTANT DATES

1851- Sojourner Truth addresses the Ohio Women's Rights Convention

WEEK 4 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 4

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.36-44 "The Bible's Books" - "the next chapter."



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→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more of the questions on p.44 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 5 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 9

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: God's Track Record

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Psalm 7
2. 2 Samuel 17

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Response to the Healing

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Introducing the New Testament p.227-228 "The book of" - "like their master."
- Read about one more major theme in Acts.

2. ESV Concise Study Bible Acts 3:11-26

→ NOTEBOOK

Add the additional theme you read about to your notebook and a brief sentence of explanation. Then record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 5 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 10

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.180-181 (The Power of Story)
2. ∞ Video Link: God's Attributes

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

- 2 Samuel 18

WEEK 5 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 5

Robert Moffat

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

"Robert Moffat is sometimes regarded as the patriarch of South African missions, a man who had a significant influence in that region for more

• DEFINITIONS

bairns: (p.136) Scottish term for child

catechism: (p.141) a summary of religious doctrine often in the form of questions and answers



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than half a century. Yet even during his own lifetime, he was overshadowed by his famous son-in-law, often being referred to as 'the father-in-law of David Livingstone.' Moffat, nevertheless, was the far greater missionary of the two. He was an evangelist, a translator, an educator, a diplomat, and an explorer, and he effectively combined those roles to become one of the truly great missionaries to Africa." (Ruth Tucker, From Jerusalem to Irian Jaya)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of Robert Moffat

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.135-141 "The setting sun" - "of Jesus Christ."
2. This short excerpt from the biography Robert Moffat: Pioneer in Africa by Cecil Northcott talks about the difficulties and joys of translating the Bible into the Tswana (also known as Setswana) language.

∞ PDF Link: Excerpt from Moffat biography

• EXTRA HELPING

This short podcast talks about the life of Robert Moffat.

∞ Link: Five Minutes in Church History Podcast

WEEK 5 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 5

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

You may have heard the Bible called The Greatest Story Ever Told. In today's reading, the author describes different elements of a story - elements you have most likely learned about in literature classes, but have you ever applied that framework to the Story of Scripture?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.45-51 "The Bible has" - "all the others."

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions. Using the elements the author is explaining, begin a diagram or chart of the Story of Scripture (you'll continue it in the second half of the chapter).

WEEK 6 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 11

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Understanding God's Sovereignty

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 19-20

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Brought Before Leadership

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The healing of the lame man brought the attention of the Jewish



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leadership to the disciples. The Sadducees mentioned in the passage were "wealthy and politically connected Jews who had control of the temple personnel but were not themselves priests. One of the distinctive elements of their doctrine was the rejection of the resurrection" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 4
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- The word "bold" or "boldness" is repeated in Acts 4. Why was boldness needed on the part of the disciples?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant. You may want to refer to Introducing the New Testament for guidance.

WEEK 6 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 12

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Differences between Ancient and Modern Worldviews

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

2 Samuel 21:1-22:25

WEEK 6 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 6

Hudson Taylor

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

"Hudson Taylor was born in Yorkshire, England, in 1832. His father was a pharmacist as well as a Methodist lay preacher who instilled in his son a passion for missions. Before he had reached his fifth birthday, the child was telling visitors that he wanted to some day be a missionary, and China (through the influence of his father) was the land that intrigued him the most...His sights were set on reaching the whole of China, all 400 million people, and to that end he labored, though not single-handedly. He had a knack for organization, and he possessed a magnetic personality that drew men and women to him and to his point of view. The China Inland Mission was his creation and was a model for future faith missions. In his own lifetime the missionary force under him grew to more than eight hundred, and in the decades following his death it continued to expand." (Ruth Tucker, From Jerusalem to Irian Jaya)

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Picture of Maria and Hudson Taylor

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.143-150 "The gathering room" - "passing in 1905."

∞ PDF Link: Excerpt from Hudson Taylor Biography p.98-101 (end at "of Chinese dress.")

This excerpt tells about the first time Hudson Taylor changed his appearance to fit into the Chinese culture. It comes from the biography J. Hudson Taylor: God's Man in China by his son and daughter-in-law. The excerpt will mention his queue, which is a braid of hair usually worn hanging at the back of the head. It begins in the middle of a chapter when

• IMPORTANT DATES

1865 - Hudson Taylor founds the China Inland Mission



Term 1

Hudson is traveling with a fellow missionary Dr. Parker, and they are looking for a place to set up a mission base. Dr. Parker gets called to minister and work at a hospital in another village, but Hudson is left alone to figure out where to go next and to find a place to rent.

- Hudson Taylor mirrored the method and motive of the Apostle Paul, who testified in 1 Corinthians 9:20: "To the Jews I became like a Jew, to win the Jews. To those under the law I became like one under the law (though I myself am not under the law), so as to win those under the law..." What do you think about his method of dressing and looking like a Chinese person in order to reach them for the gospel? What would be the benefits, and what might be some objections?

WEEK 6 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 6

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.52-56 "Most epic fantasies" - "only the beginning."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more of the questions on p.56 to answer in your notebook. Complete the diagram you began last week of the Story of Scripture. As the author mentions on p.55, mark where you are in the story (by drawing a stick figure, writing your name, or marking it however you want to signify YOU!). Copy Acts 1:8 into the chart above where you are marked. From your reading in Acts and the ideas presented in this chapter about the Story of Scripture, what would you say your mission is as a believer in the Lord?

WEEK 7 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 13

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.376-378 "We are now" - "importance of context."
2. 2 Samuel 22:26-51
3. Psalm 18:1-24

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Ananias and Sapphira

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 4:32-37; Acts 5:1-42
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- How did the offering of Barnabas compare with the offering of Ananias and Sapphira?



Term 1

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 7 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 14

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Psalm 18:25-50
2. 2 Samuel 23

WEEK 7 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 7

Fact Files: The Gospel in Difficult Places

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

Today you will learn about two figures from church history that spend their life preaching the gospel in unique ways. The first man is mostly unknown to most people, but the second man was one of the most famous people in America at that time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1. p.151-152 "You don't have" - "Apostle of Greenland."
 2. Listen (or read) more about Hans Egede.
- ∞ Audio Link: Hans Egede Story (can end at 5:44)

→ READ, NARRATE, & VIEW

1. p.152-153 "Although we have" - "Asbury's tireless efforts."
 2. Watch this video that tells about the impact of Asbury in America in the 19th century.
- ∞ Video link: Francis Asbury (can end at 7:00)

WEEK 7 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 7

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.57-64 "God's will for" - "faith? Do we?"

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions.

WEEK 8 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 15

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms and 2 Samuel last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Chronicles 18-20



Term 1

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Stephen is Introduced

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In the book of Acts, Luke periodically gives a "progress report" of the early church. In verse 7, he gives a report that is glowing! But with all these additional people come additional responsibilities that must be taken care of. Chapter 6 will show the movement into the second part of the mission Jesus gave the disciples in Acts 1:8, before he ascended into heaven: that of the gospel moving out from Jerusalem to "all Judea and Samaria."

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 6
- (Optional) Read the notes on chapter 6 in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 8 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 16

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

- OT Today p.374-375 (Interior Psalms Book 2)
- Psalms 60
- 2 Samuel 24

WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 8

Fact Files: The Gospel in Difficult Places

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

You will read about two more individuals who brought the message of Christ into "difficult landscapes."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-155 "Although Soren Kierkegaard" - "one already lives."

→ VIEW

In this video, theologian R.C. Sproul talks through one of Kierkegaard's philosophical concepts.

∞ Video Link: Kierkegaard and the Leap of Faith (5:00)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.155-157 "While Kierkegaard stayed" - "wisdom, and humility."



Term 1

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Image of David Griffiths

WEEK 8 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 8

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.64-72 "While Moses was" - "the next chapter."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more questions to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 9 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 17

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 1

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Stephen's Sermon

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Stephen is charged with blasphemy for speaking "against the law and the temple, both of which had attained a sacred status in Judaism. To speak disrespectfully about them was considered criminal. To suggest that the temple and the law were inadequate or would pass away was heresy. It was taken as strongly as someone today undermining democracy, freedom, or human rights...Stephen's speech showed his respect for...the law, the Tabernacle, and the temple...It was important for Luke to show that Stephen was executed based on false (unsubstantiated) accusations and his association with Jesus" (Bible Story Handbook). While the reports of the church's growth are tremendously encouraging, the story of Stephen's martyrdom showed the persecution the Christians faced and the anger with which the leadership viewed these new believers.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 7
2. (Optional) Read the notes of the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



Term 1

WEEK 9 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 18

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 2

WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 9

Dwight Moody

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ INTRO

"Except for two twentieth-century evangelists, Billy Sunday and Billy Graham, no American has had the privilege of personally presenting the gospel of Jesus Christ to so many people. Indeed, by the time of D.L. Moody's death in 1899, the secretary of the International Committee of the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) declared that 'Mr. Moody delivered the gospel message in a larger number of places, to a larger number of persons, a larger number of times than any man who ever lived.'" (Lyle Dorsett, *A Passion for Souls*) Perhaps you have never heard of D.L. Moody, but he has impacted many lives, and his impact continues through the college Moody Bible Institute in Chicago, Illinois.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.159-167 "The four men" - "all things easy."

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Our Founder: D.L. Moody

WEEK 9 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 9

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.73-79 "God's word commands" - "him will grow."

→ NOTEBOOK

Take a moment to record new insights, copy quotes, or ask questions.

WEEK 10 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 19

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. I Chronicles 21
2. Psalms 4-5



Term 1

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

Saul, Philip, Simon, & The Ethiopian Eunuch

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Through the end of Acts 7, Luke has described the preaching of the gospel in Jerusalem. It had been effective. Thousands had believed. In fact, others had flocked into the city to be with the apostles and had experienced the healings that were taking place. Now, beginning with chapter 8, the gospel expands to Samaria, and Philip becomes the instrument of the first great missionary outreach (James M. Boice, Acts: An Expositional Commentary).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 8
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 10 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 20

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles and the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

- OT Today p.351 (Vindication and Appeasement)
- Psalms 6; 9-10

WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 10

Bible Translation

Materials: Links

→ INTRO

If the Bible had never been translated into English, would you be able to read and understand God's message of salvation? We read about many different missionaries who translated the Bible into the native language of the people. Translation work continues to this day. Here are the latest statistics from Wycliffe Bible Translators (wycliffe.org.uk/statistics/): 1 in 5 people are still waiting for the Bible in their language, 7,393 languages in the world, 3,248 languages have no Scripture—yet (down 20 from last month).

Today you will watch videos about Bible translation and how technology is speeding up the translation process in unprecedented ways.

→ VIEW

- ∞ Video Link: Translating for Understanding
- ∞ Video Link: Church-Led Bible Translation in the Pacific
- ∞ Video Link: Solving the Technical Challenges

(Optional) You can explore the Wycliffe Translators website to learn more



Term 1

about Bible translation in different regions.
 ∞ Link: Global Overview

- What did you learn about Bible translation that you didn't know before?
- How has technology helped the process?
- What questions do you still have about it?

WEEK 10 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 10

📖 Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.79-84 "We saw earlier" - "transformed by truth."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose one or more questions to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 11 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 21

📖 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.352-354 "While we enjoy" - "to the pit."
2. Psalms 11-14; 16-17

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Saul's Conversion

📖 Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Saul is brought back into the picture in chapter 9, with the story of his conversion. To the Jewish leaders, "the claim that Jesus is God was a major heresy and a threat to Judaism and had to be eliminated" (Bible Story Handbook). This is exactly what Saul's mission is at the opening of chapter 9. He wanted to persecute and eliminate the people of "The Way." Christians are called this a few times in the New Testament. Do you have an idea why? (Hint: John 14:6)

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 9:1-30
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What does Saul's testimony teach us about the character of God and who God is?

→ VIEW

🖼 Image Resource: Introducing the New Testament
 Take a moment to look at the painting on p.218 (Fig. 10.3 The Call of Paul). Describe what you see in the painting. He Qi is a contemporary Christian artist who is influenced by Chinese traditional folk art.

• EXTRA HELPING

This interesting article tells how He Qi became a Christian and an artist during a turbulent time in China.

∞ **Article Link:** Article about artist He Qi



Term 1

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 11 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 22

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Psalm 22; 25
2. OT Today p.409-412 (Devotional Use of the Psalms)

WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 11

Catch-Up Day

Materials: Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 11

Materials: Linked article

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

As the author has discussed, part of studying the Bible is understanding the "Big Story" of the Bible and its metanarrative. What does it mean for the Bible to be read as literature? Instead of God giving us a bullet-point list of attributes about who he is and what he is like, he shows us his character through the stories of how he interacted with people. Just as fictional stories use different elements such as characters, setting, plot, climax, and resolution to tell a good story, the Bible uses the same elements to tell the true stories of God's people. When we understand these elements better, we can understand the Bible better. "A book needs to be read in keeping with its author's intention. We can see from the Bible itself that it is a thoroughly literary book. God superintended its authors to write a very (though not wholly) literary book. Paying adequate attention to the literary qualities of the Bible not only helps to unlock the meanings of the Bible; it is also a way of honoring the literary intentions of its authors. Surely, biblical authors regarded everything they put into their writing as important. We also need to regard those things as important." (How Bible Stories Work, p.10) This quote is from Leland Ryken, a retired professor and author. Today's reading is an article Ryken wrote about reading the Bible as literature.

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: Ten Things You Should Know About the Bible as Literature

→ NOTEBOOK

Add any notes, thoughts, or questions about the article in your notebook.

WEEK 12 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 23

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Term 1	
Answer question(s) related to course.	
WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Acts	
WEEK 12 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 24 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Renewal: The Church Expands Outward	
WEEK 12 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Transformed by Truth	



Term 2

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 25

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Prayer

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 26-28; 31

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Peter and Cornelius

Materials: ESV Concise Study, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The end of chapter 9 and chapter 10 focus on Peter. Peter continues to minister, heal, and preach the gospel. In 9:31, Luke gives another progress report on the church. How does he define the early church's health and growth? In chapter 10, the story of Cornelius is a "key turning point in the book as the church is officially opened up to Gentiles" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 9:31-43; Acts 10
2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ VIEW

Image Resource: Introducing the New Testament
Take a moment to look at the painting on p.217 (Fig. 10.2 A heavenly revelation). Describe what you see in the painting.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 26

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 35-36

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 13

The Boy and the Books

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading last time in Church History?

→ INTRO

• IMPORTANT DATES

June 19, 1834 - Charles H. Spurgeon born



Term 2

The next book we will be reading in Church History is a biography about Charles H. Spurgeon. Born in 1834, Spurgeon was a pastor and author who lived a life of faithful ministry. His devotional writings are still read by many today. You may put the date of Spurgeon's birth into your book of centuries.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.1 p.3-12 "I would rather" - "as a barn."

Optional: "Conditions in England During Spurgeon's Time" p.xv-xvii

WEEK 1 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 13

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

As we move into the second half of Transformed by Truth, we will look at the how of Bible study.

→ READ & NARRATE

p.87-99 "What's the right" - "about our God."

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the three questions on p.99.

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 27

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.370-373 "The seam Psalms" - "in each book."

2. Psalms 38; 40-41

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Peter Tells of His Vision

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

News that Gentiles had also received the word of God and the Holy Spirit spread fast from Caesarea to Jerusalem. It is important to recognize that Jews familiar with their own Scriptures were not put off with the fact that the gospel was proclaimed to the Gentiles or that they shared in the promises of God...The issue that the "circumcised" believers had with Peter's encounter with the "uncircumcised" is not that they received the word of God from Peter, but the circumstances of the reception. The concern they had was that Peter went into a Gentile home and ate with them; the issue is one of purity. Of course, this was the identical problem Peter had himself before going to Cornelius's home (Dean Pinter, The Story of God Bible Commentary). The "circumcised" (a sign of the covenant) refers to the Jews, and the "uncircumcised" refers to the Gentiles.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 11



Term 2

2. (Optional) Read notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 28

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 53; 55; 58; 61

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 14

Conversion & Joy in Serving

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-27 "In the summer" - "had been baptized."

- On p.21 the author makes a statement that reads like a thesis statement or main point of what will be coming in the book: "The failure of preachers he had heard to present the gospel, and to do so in a plain, direct manner, caused him throughout his whole ministry to tell sinners in every sermon and in a most forthright and understandable way how to be saved." How do you think having this goal or idea in mind helped Spurgeon in his ministry? As we continue reading the biography of his life, note in what ways he stays consistent with this important point in his ministry.

WEEK 2 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 14

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.101-107 "I know I" - "to give it."

→ NOTEBOOK

List the three pillars of inductive Bible study. Write down any quotes, phrases, or ideas that stand out from the reading.

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 29

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 64; 69



Term 2

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Peter Freed from Prison

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In this passage, King Herod is the grandson of Herod who ruled at the time of Jesus' birth. He was new to the throne, so "it is easy to see why this ruler...was interested in gaining favor with the ruling Jewish council" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 12
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 30

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 70-71; 86

WEEK 3 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 15

The Boy Preacher

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.28-29 "Nearly four months" - "begin to preach."
p.31-40 "In the summer" - "Church in London."

- The author divides the book into four main parts, with today's reading closing out the first part of the book. What are three main events from these early years of Spurgeon's life that stood out to you that seem to be preparing him for a life of ministry?

WEEK 3 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 15

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook, Bible study supplies as needed (see below)

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.108-112 "The first step" - "of a masterpiece."
As you read, jot down what the author recommends for supplies for Bible study. Gather these supplies and print out Acts 17 for your inductive Bible



Term 2

study. (If you want the chapter to be double-spaced as the author recommends, you will need to copy and paste the chapter into a separate document to adjust the line spacing there.)

∞ Link: Acts 17 (ESV)

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the three questions on p.112.

WEEK 4 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 31

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.375-376 (Interior Psalms Book 4 and 5)
2. Psalms 102; 109

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Paul Begins His First Missionary Journey

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

This week in Spiritual Formation, you will begin an in-depth study of chapter 17 of Acts, which will accompany your reading in Transformed by Truth. As we continue to read Acts, we will gain a larger context for the book and the early church's growth, which helps when studying a specific verse or even a single word.

The focus switches from Peter to the Apostle Paul. It continues to follow the pattern of the key verse, Acts 1:8, as Paul and Barnabas begin a missionary journey that would take them approximately 1,400 miles between AD 46-48 (Bible Story Handbook). Having seen Barnabas' name a few times already in Acts, why do you think he would be a good choice as a missionary?

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 13 (You may want to read and narrate shorter sections.)
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ VIEW

Map Resource: Introducing the New Testament
Look at map 10.1 on p.206. Trace the route of Paul's first missionary journey. Where did most of his travels take place?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 4 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 32

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?



Term 2

→ **READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND**
Psalms 139-141

WEEK 4 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 16

Called to Be a Pastor

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS**

p.43-53 "A man named" - "did them part."

→ **VIEW**

Image Resource: Spurgeon: A Biography - images located after p.87
View the first four pages of pictures in your book (located after p.87).
Look at the image of Spurgeon at the age of 20 (around the time of being called as a pastor). Do you think those who put him down for his young age had a point? Why or why not?

• IMPORTANT DATES

April 1854 - Begins pastorship in London at the age of 19

WEEK 4 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 16

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ **RECAP**

What did you read about last time?

→ **READ & NARRATE**

Ch.8 p.113-124

(Instead of studying 3 John as the author suggests, we will study Acts 17 to go along with your New Testament reading beginning in the next lesson.)

→ **NOTEBOOK**

Take notes on today's reading of chapter 8. Note the three types of context and what is included in each.

WEEK 5 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 33

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ **RECAP**

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND**

Psalms 143; 37

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Paul and Barnabas Continue to Preach

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ **RECAP**

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ **INTRO**

Paul and Barnabas continue on their first missionary journey. What is the gospel message they are preaching? Why do you think the gospel message brings opposition?

→ **READ & NARRATE**



Term 2

1. Acts 14 (You may want to read and narrate shorter sections.)
 2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.
- Discuss what 14:22b meant to Paul and Barnabas and what it might mean for you: "Through many tribulations we must enter the kingdom of God."

WEEK 5 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 34

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Chronicles 22-23

WEEK 5 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 17

Charles and Susannah

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

NOTE: We will skip chapter 7 for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.6 p.55-62 "Although most boys" - "made in heaven."
p.77-81 "For three years" - "salvation of souls."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Charles and Susannah at a Young Age

∞ Image Link: The Crystal Palace

View the images at the links to see Charles and Susannah at a young age and the Crystal Palace in London.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Jan. 8, 1856 - Charles and Susannah Married

WEEK 5 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 17

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

In today's lesson, we will apply the information from chapter 8 of Transformed by Truth to our study in Acts.

→ READ

Using at least two different resources, look up and read an introduction to Acts to find information about the Historical, Biblical, and Cultural context of Acts. The Ultimate Bible Atlas, The Chronological Guide to the Bible, and the ESV Concise Study Bible you use in your Bible reading all contain contextual background information. Alternatively, you could use an online site such as Bible Project or Blue Letter Bible, or ask a parent what Bible commentaries or Bible dictionaries they may have that could be used.

∞ Link: Blue Letter Bible (click on Tools for commentaries)

∞ Link: The Bible Project

→ NOTEBOOK

From your reading of two different resources, write three facts or points



Term 2

under each of the three types of context (Biblical, Historical, Cultural). (e.g., under Historical Context, you could write the date range of the acts that were written.)

WEEK 6 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 35

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Chronicles 24-25

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Jerusalem Council

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"After Peter declared the universal lordship of Jesus to Cornelius and his household, Luke describes how the early church in Antioch got on with this mission to "the world" by sending out Paul and Barnabas. By all accounts, this first mission journey to the Gentile world was a success. Yet its very success brought the early church to a crossroads. Today, you will read about the Jerusalem Council, which was a crucial moment in the story of the early church. The stakes were high. The decision the early church would make here would shape who they would be (identity) and how they would be together (unity). In this council, the leadership of the early church would deal with the question: What is to be the basis of the inclusion of Gentiles in the newly constituted people of God?" (The Story of the Bible Commentary).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 15
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 6 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 36

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. I Chronicles 26
2. Psalms 30; 15; 24

WEEK 6 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 18

The Church Grows

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: Today's reading is a bit shorter. Use any extra time to catch up on reading or to read the article at the link.



Term 2

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Spurgeon placed importance on prayer and on the people who were attending his church. Their conversion was a deep desire of his heart. The church he led put into place some ways of following up with those who professed salvation and who wanted to be members. As you read, consider how these ideas would work in a modern church today.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.81-87 "His was a" - "great Metropolitan Temple."

- Do you think any of the ideas the church implemented to follow up with those who wanted to be members were helpful? Would any of those ideas work in a modern church? Why or why not?

→ OPTIONAL: READ THE LINKED ARTICLE CONTAINING A VISITOR'S EXPERIENCE HEARING SPURGEON PREACH.

∞ Article Link: What It Was Like to Hear Charles Spurgeon Preach

→ VIEW

Take some time to look at the rest of the images included in the book (located after p.87). What do you notice?

WEEK 6 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 18

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ

p.125-132 "When I was" - "to them soon!"

Take notes as you read about what questions are being answered when you look at the bigger picture or "airplane window view," and then the close-up picture or the "walking the streets" view.

→ NOTEBOOK

Using your notes on your reading, apply these questions to Acts as a whole (you have already done some, if not all, of this in the last lesson and in your reading of Acts).

Next, use your Acts 17 printout to answer the chapter's six close-up view questions (who, what, when, where, why, how).

WEEK 7 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 37

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles and the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 42-45



Term 2

WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Conversion of Lydia

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In Acts 15:36, Paul's second missionary journey begins with Silas, Timothy, and Luke joining him. This second journey would take them approximately 2,800 miles between AD 49-52, with much of their time spent in the city of Corinth (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 16
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ VIEW

Map Resource: Introducing the New Testament
Look at map 10.2 on p.207. Trace the route of Paul's second missionary journey. How is this one different from the first?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 7 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 38

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

- Psalms 46-48
- OT Today p.406-409 "Should our worship" - "for the peace."

WEEK 7 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 19

The Metropolitan Tabernacle

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography, Book of Centuries

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The Metropolitan Tabernacle would be the church where Spurgeon would spend the rest of his days as a preacher. In today's reading, he will also speak to a record-setting crowd of 23,654 at The Crystal Palace, the place he and Susannah had spent so much time. Imagine speaking - with just your voice! - to that large a crowd!

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.9 p.91-99 "Spurgeon had been" - "called him home."

→ VIEW

Image Link: Metropolitan Tabernacle
The link shows the Metropolitan Tabernacle in more recent times. The

• IMPORTANT DATES

March 31, 1861 - First Sunday Service at the Metropolitan Tabernacle

• EXTRA HELPING

Read the sermon Spurgeon preached to the record-setting crowd at The Crystal Palace.

Article Link: Spurgeon's Fast-Day Sermon



Term 2

Tabernacle is still active as a church to this day, although it has had to be rebuilt twice, once due to a fire and then after a bombing during World War II. It has a slightly different design to its front after its latest rebuild.

WEEK 7 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 19

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.132-140 "Now that we're" - "study so far."
Take notes as you read.

→ NOTEBOOK

Using your Acts 17 printout, do the following:

- Read through Acts 17 looking for repeated words, themes, or phrases. Some examples are given below, but if you find any others on your own, mark those.
- Mark all words related to thinking, studying, and reasoning (synonyms or antonyms) in red.
- Mark all cities Paul travels to in green.
- Mark all names of people mentioned in brown.
- Mark any reactions of people listening to the message Paul is preaching in blue. Is there a difference in reactions from different groups or individuals?
- If you find any other themes you want to mark, do so now. Ideas might include action words (persuaded, joined, attacked, etc.), responses from women, or words referring to or having to do with God (Lord, word of God, etc.).
- What is the main issue that is making the people angry?

WEEK 8 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 39

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.375 (Interior Psalms Book 3)
2. Psalms 49; 84-85

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Paul Speaks to the Areopagus

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In the context of the entire book of Acts, we have reached chapter 17, the chapter you're studying closely in your Transformed by Truth reading. While you are already familiar with what takes place in this chapter because of your study, reread it in the context of the book of Acts and in the context of Paul's second missionary journey.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 17
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.



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WEEK 8 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 40

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Chronicles 26-27

WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 20

The Pastors' College

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The next couple of chapters start to show the growth of Spurgeon's ministry outside of his pastorship. First, a college is started to train young pastors.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.10 p.101-109 "During Spurgeon's first" - "for needy children."

WEEK 8 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 20

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.141-146 "What do you" - "makes it interpretation."

→ NOTEBOOK

1. Using the author's example on p.145, write a summary (paraphrase) of Acts 17. For instance, your first point might read: Paul and Silas arrive in Thessalonica, where Paul teaches in the synagogue (vs.1-3).
2. Keeping in mind the main idea of Acts, which shows the growth of the early church, how does Acts 17 fit into the flow of the book? How does what Luke includes in his synopsis of events help support his main purpose in writing Acts?

WEEK 9 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 41

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Chronicles 28-29



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WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Aquila and Priscilla

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul continues to be helped in his ministry by acquaintances he meets. In Acts 18, Aquila and Priscilla help encourage Paul and minister alongside him, and later in the chapter, they kindly teach Apollos. The flow of the book of Acts shows the growth of the early church and shows how these individuals (people like Lydia, Aquila, Priscilla, Luke, etc.) were used by God to help build the church. Interestingly, Gallio mentioned here is the brother of Seneca, a (still to this day) famous Stoic philosopher. (Remember Paul's message in chapter 17 specifically included Stoicism when he preached against the Greeks and their philosophy.) Paul's third missionary journey begins in Acts 18:22 (some lists may say verse 23).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 18
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What does the involvement of individuals of all backgrounds in the church's growth tell us about God and his character and who he is?

→ VIEW

Map Resource: Introducing the New Testament
Look at map 10.3 on p.208. Trace the route of Paul's third missionary journey. Is the route more similar to the first or the second journey?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 9 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 42

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Chronicles last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 87; 2; 20-21

WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 21

New Ways of Reaching the Community

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: Parts of this chapter will be skipped for the sake of time.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.111-113 "In 1865 Spurgeon" - "build God's work."
p.115-122 "But though Spurgeon" - "days on earth."

- The church began reaching out into the community by publishing a



Term 2

magazine, printing sermons, and building new churches. In what ways is the message of the gospel spread by the church you attend? Are any of those ways similar to what the Metropolitan Tabernacle used? What new (modern) ways does your church use to reach the surrounding community?

WEEK 9 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 21

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.146-155 "The heart of" - "the next chapter."

(Use the questions below as we focus on Acts 17, instead of the book's questions.)

→ NOTEBOOK

1. Read Acts 17 again. Read Paul's sermon in verses 22-31 again. Why does Paul focus on idols in his message? What had the philosophers (such as the Epicureans and Stoics) made an idol of?

2. Look up the following cross-references for "philosophers" and write down any observations you may have: 1 Corinthians 1:20-21; Romans 1:22; Colossians 2:6-8.

3. Pick another verse or passage from Acts 17 that you would like to study more closely. Use a Bible Dictionary, or footnotes in a Study Bible, to research the passage's meaning. (Blueletterbible.org links to study notes or dictionaries if you cannot access one.) Write observations in your notebook.

∞ Link: Blue Letter Bible

4. Use either the online Blue Letter Bible or a Strong's Concordance to look up the Strong's number, Greek word, and definition for the word "babbling" found in Acts 17:18.

5. Using a commentary from your home, church, or library, look up the passage and write down any notes about what you learn about the passage. (Blueletterbible.org also has links to commentaries.)

WEEK 10 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 43

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 72; 93-94

WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

Paul Against the Goddess Diana

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Introducing the New Testament

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Paul's third missionary journey begins in chapter 18, covering approximately 2,700 miles from 53-57 AD. More than half of his time would be spent in Ephesus.

→ VIEW



Term 2

📖 Image Resource: Introducing the New Testament p.220

Look at Fig. 10.4, which shows the city of Ephesus. Ephesus was the third largest city at that time and home of one of the seven wonders of the ancient world—the temple of Artemis (Diana), the goddess of the hunt.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 19
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

WEEK 10 📅 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 44

📖 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Psalms 95-98

WEEK 10 📅 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 22

Widows & Orphans

📖 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.125-130 "Dr. John Rippon" - "HIM BE GOD."

p.133-137 "From the late" - "of the gout."

James 1:27: "Religion that is pure and undefiled before God the Father is this: to visit orphans and widows in their affliction, and to keep oneself unstained from the world."

- Based on today's reading and the verse above, do you agree or disagree with the author's statement that "The orphanage was a lasting demonstration of the fact that Spurgeon's faith was not mere theory but that it produced good works" (p.130)? Why or why not?

WEEK 10 📅 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 22

📖 Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.157-168 "Can you imagine" - "and forevermore. Amen."

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer the questions regarding the application on p.168 (based on Acts 17). Choose a verse or a short passage from Acts 17 to memorize if you would like.

WEEK 11 📅 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 45

📖 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in the Psalms last time?



Term 2

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Psalms 99; 101; 110; 144
2. (Optional) OT Today p.375 (25 of the Most Familiar Psalm Lines)

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

WEEK 11 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 46

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Psalms last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 3-4

WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 23

Mrs. Spurgeon

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Charles Spurgeon's wife Susannah was a big part of his ministry, and today's chapter brings her work into the picture. Mrs. Spurgeon suffered from a medical illness that kept her from traveling or even attending church services for much of her adult life. However, today's reading will show how God brought together her unique abilities to minister to others and enabled her to have an impact on many.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.137-150 "Of this attack" - "and comfort others."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Susie Spurgeon

WEEK 11 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 23

Materials: Transformed By Truth, notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read about last time?

→ INTRO

While you have reached the end of Transformed by Truth, what you have learned can be used to study any passage of the Bible. As you continue reading the book of Acts, remember the specific things you have learned from chapter 17 and apply that to the bigger context of Acts and, ultimately, to the overarching context of the entire Bible.

→ READ & NARRATE

Appendix B: Memorization Tips and Helps p.177-180

- Continue working on the verse or passage you have chosen to memorize from Acts 17.



Term 2	
→ NOTEBOOK Create a worksheet or outline highlighting the key points from Transformed by Truth about the how and why of Bible study. What information would you include if you were teaching a class about inductive Bible study?	
WEEK 12 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 47 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Acts	
WEEK 12 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 48 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course.	
WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Spurgeon: A Biography	
WEEK 12 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 24 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Transformed by Truth	



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 49

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.324-328 "The wisdom literature" - "assumed of Job." (Can skip p.325)
2. ∞ Video Link: Wisdom Literature

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Proverbs 1-2

WEEK 1 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Eutychus Falls Asleep

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

In Acts 20, the story of Eutychus stands out as an interesting story of Paul healing a young man who fell out of a window...while listening to Paul speak! The presence of many lamps was not usual, but it gave the idea that the meeting had been planned to go into the night. "Possibly the heat or even odor from the lamps contributed to Eutychus seeking a window seat. Glass was rare in windows. Some windows could be large, especially above the ground floor" (Cultural Backgrounds Study Bible).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 20
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What are your thoughts about Paul's final message to the Ephesian elders? What does the emotional reaction on both sides tell you about their relationship?

→ NOTEBOOK

Pick one of the locations Paul went to and write a short description of the events that took place there.

WEEK 1 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 50

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. Read OT Today p.330 Section titled "All the Wisdom of the East"
2. ∞ Video Link: Proverbs

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Proverbs 3-4



Term 3

WEEK 1 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 25

The Lively Church

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.153-161 "The Metropolitan Tabernacle" - "it all about."

WEEK 1 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 25

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about the overall message of Transformed by Truth?

→ INTRO

In this lesson, we will begin the book This Changes Everything: How the Gospel Transforms the Teen Years. The author states in her intro that this book is for young people who want to grow in their spiritual life. "...Because we love Jesus. If we love Jesus, we'll love truth, and we'll want to grow" (p.14). And - as the title states - the author shows how the gospel changes our entire life and touches every area of our existence.

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.1 p.17-29

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions on p.29 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 51

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. Read OT Today p.343-346 "To bridge the" - "is not true."
2. ∞ Video Link: Theme of Order

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Proverbs 5-6

WEEK 2 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

Paul Goes to Jerusalem

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

The missionary journeys are completed, Paul is going to Jerusalem for the last time, and arrives there in this chapter. He is arrested and so far as we know never again finds freedom.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 21:1-36



Term 3

2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- How does this passage show the progress of the spread of the early church in obedience to Acts 1:8?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 2 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 52

 Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. Read OT Today p.346-348 "Even a casual" - "creation more accurately."
2. ∞ Video Link: How Can the Idea of Order Help us Discern God's Will

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Proverbs 7-8

WEEK 2 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 26

Books

 Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

In today's reading, Spurgeon's library of 12,000 books is mentioned. Spurgeon felt it was imperative that those who were teaching the Bible be learned and readers of books. In fact, he gave two pieces of advice about books to students: 1. Buy a few, high-quality books; 2. "Master those books you have." "Read them thoroughly," he wrote. "Bathe in them until they saturate you. Read and re-read them, masticate them, and digest them. Let them go into your very self. Peruse a good book several times, and make notes and analyses of it. A student will find that his mental constitution is more affected by one book thoroughly mastered than by twenty books which he has merely skimmed, lapping at them, as the classic proverb puts it 'As the dogs drink of Nilus.'"

He is also quoted as having said, "Visit many good books, but live in the Bible." As time allows, view the extra helping link to see a tour of a library that now holds half of his collection of books, including a commentary on Psalms from 1476.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.16 p.163-175 "Between 1875 and" - "of the work."

• EXTRA HELPING

View the video at the link to see the library where 6,000 of Spurgeon's books are kept. Begin at 17:20-24:05.

∞ Video Link: Spurgeon's Library Tour

WEEK 2 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 26

 Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time about how the gospel changes our identity?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.2 p.31-42



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- Toward the beginning of the year, lessons 5 and 6 covered the chapter in Transformed by Truth that focused on the Story of the Bible. Today's reading also covered the subject. Why is it good to be reminded of the overarching story of the Bible? Are you able to see yourself as part of that story? Why or why not? Is there any part of this subject you think the authors missed in their chapters?

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions from p.42-43 and answer them in your notebook.

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 53

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.378-381 "The purpose of" - "remembering important lessons."
2. Proverbs 9-10

WEEK 3 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Paul Speaks to the People

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Paul recounted his Jewish background and training as a Pharisee, his zeal in persecuting Christians, and his experience on the road to Damascus. He did not refer explicitly to his status as a Christian, for that was not a choice against his Jewish identity. The crowd was enraged when he told them of his call to preach to the Gentiles, for a Jew to recognize Jesus as the Messiah was not as objectionable as a Jew who reduced or eliminated boundaries between Jew and Gentile. The next day in the Sanhedrin, neither the identity of Jesus nor the mission to the Gentiles caused problems; it was the question of the resurrection" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 21:37-40; Acts 22
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 3 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 54

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.381-382 "How then are" - "of the Lord."
2. Proverbs 11-12



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WEEK 3 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 27

Spurgeon's Character

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.17 p.177-188 "So pronounced a" - "to your souls."

WEEK 3 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 27

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time about the story of the Bible?

→ INTRO

Would you consider yourself an introvert or an extrovert? Maybe the word "community" is a bit intimidating! Today's chapter is about how the gospel affects our relationship with the people in our church. And thankfully, there's space for both introverts and extroverts!

→ READ & NARRATE

p.45-56 "The gospel is" - "change anybody's life."

→ NOTEBOOK

The author points out that part of loving your church is praying for those who are in it. Create a prayer list or write out a prayer for people - leaders, friends, other families, or kids your age - in your church. Write out any other responses or thoughts about the author's points about community.

• EXTRA HELPING

View the video at the link where Bible teacher Mike Winger goes through Eight Reasons God Wants You to Go to Church. Write the reasons and excuses he gives, and then write a short response in your notebook.

∞ **Video Link:** 8 Reasons God Wants You to Go to Church

WEEK 4 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 55

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.396 (Is It Unbiblical to Be Rich and/or Happy?)
2. Proverbs 13-14

WEEK 4 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Paul Before the Council

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

Do you think of circumstances as being things that are against you—something that God cannot control? Have you ever found yourself thinking, "If the circumstances of my life were different, perhaps then I could have been somebody or could have done something great for God or could have triumphed in the particular difficulty in which I am now"? Do not think that way. Circumstances do not limit God. Circumstances are



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not independent of God. God creates circumstances. God is the master of circumstances (Acts: An Expositional Commentary). In this chapter, we will see how God uses an interesting circumstance to save Paul from being murdered.

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 23
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 4 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 56

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Application and Relevance

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Proverbs 15-16

WEEK 4 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 28

Spurgeon As An Author

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.18 p.191-201 "From the time" - "an unexampled degree."

Optional: Read the linked passage from Spurgeon's Morning and Evening Devotional book.

∞ Link: Morning and Evening Devotional

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: The Sword & The Trowel

View the link to see the magazine published by Spurgeon, "The Sword & The Trowel."

WEEK 4 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 28

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.57-67 "So make your" - "We are free."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions on p.62 to answer in your notebook.



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WEEK 5 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 57

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Proverbs 17-18

WEEK 5 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Paul Before Felix

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"In this portion of the trial, Paul was accused of being a troublemaker who stirred up riots as a leader of the Christians. His opponents added the charge of desecrating the temple. Paul denied the charges, but did identify himself as a Jew and follower of the Way" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 24
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- Why do you think Felix brings his wife to visit Paul and listen to him talk about the gospel?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 5 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 58

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

- OT Today p.399-400 "Proverbs speaks often" - "practice those virtues."
- Proverbs 19-20

★ TEACHER NOTE

Note the discussion of sexual ethics on p.399.

WEEK 5 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 29

Controversy

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

There are two parts to your reading today. First, read the assigned pages in the biography of Spurgeon that discuss a controversy that came up. There was a movement called Higher Criticism that moved through churches in the mid-1800s. This movement caused people to have a lower view of the Bible, which Spurgeon was highly motivated to argue against. After reading the pages in the book, read the linked sermon that



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Spurgeon spoke during this time. You may split the sermon reading between this week and next week to fit the time allotted.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.19 p.205-209 "The Metropolitan Tabernacle" - "their firm opposition."

∞ Link: Poverty and Riches Sermon by Spurgeon

If needed, the sermon may be divided between this week and next week's lesson time.

WEEK 5 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 29

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.67-77 "But even though" - "break his promises."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions listed to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 6 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 59

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. OT Today p.400-403 "When pediatrician Benjamin" - "in serious trouble."

2. Proverbs 21-22

WEEK 6 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Paul Before Agrippa

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Festus succeeded Felix and heard the same charges that his predecessor had heard two years earlier. Paul knew that Festus was currying favor with the Jews and that he might be inclined to turn Paul over to them, which would have been catastrophic. As a Roman citizen, Paul had a right to appeal to Caesar, and he did so" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 25

2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

• What do you think about Festus' response of not having anything by which to charge Paul?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.



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WEEK 6 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 60

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Proverbs last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 5-6

WEEK 6 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 30

Glory Dwelleth in Immanuel's Land

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

NOTE: A few pages are skipped at the beginning of the chapter for time's sake. Assigned pages are listed below.

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

Toward the end of his life, Spurgeon experienced much physical pain and sickness. However, he held tight to his faith and looked forward to being with his Savior.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.224-233 "He found relief" - "is far better."

∞ Link: Poverty and Riches Sermon by Spurgeon

Complete your reading of the sermon if needed.

• IMPORTANT DATES

January 31, 1892 - Charles H. Spurgeon Dies

WEEK 6 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 30

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.79-89 "Let's pretend there" - "our prayer life."

→ NOTEBOOK

Take some time to consider the following questions, and write out your thoughts or answers in your notebook: Do you think of the word "discipline" in a positive or negative way? Or does it depend on the context? What spiritual disciplines have you implemented in your life? What spiritual discipline(s) would you like to focus on? Write out a prayer asking the Lord for help in doing so.

WEEK 7 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 61

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 7



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WEEK 7 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Paul Defends Himself to Agrippa

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"Nothing [in Paul's testimony] indicates that he was making proselytes to Judaism, thus indicating that this message had nothing to do with Jewish law. Agrippa was astonished at the claim when he referenced Christ and his resurrection. Despite that, he was persuaded that the charges against Paul by the Jews were unfounded. This finding is very important to the case Luke has been making throughout the book" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

- Acts 26
- (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- What do you think Luke's purpose is in presenting these different trials where Paul is put on the defense of himself?

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 7 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 62

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 8

WEEK 7 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 31

Spurgeon's Funeral

Materials: Spurgeon: A Biography

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading about Spurgeon from last time?

→ INTRO

The final chapter of the book covers Spurgeon's funeral.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.234-244 "At the close" - "Charles Haddon Spurgeon."

- In the first lesson on the biography of Spurgeon, we noted the author makes a statement that reads like a thesis statement or main point of what Spurgeon strived to keep in mind when telling others about the gospel (p.21): "The failure of preachers he had heard to present the gospel, and to do so in a plain, direct manner, caused him throughout his whole ministry to tell sinners in every sermon and in a most forthright and understandable way how to be saved." Now that you have read more on Spurgeon, do you think he was able to remain faithful to this goal or aim of his ministry? How?



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WEEK 7 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 31

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.89-95 "Only recently have" - "our evangelizing: Jesus."

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions from p.95-96 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 8 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 63

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

I Kings 9-10

WEEK 8 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Shipwreck

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook, Introducing the New Testament (optional)

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

After all the trials he has been through, Paul is on his way to Rome. Unfortunately, he faces a different kind of difficulty this time. However, through it all, "God preserved Paul because he still had work for him to do" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 27
2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

→ NOTEBOOK

Record anything from today's reading under any of the themes that might be relevant.

WEEK 8 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 64

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in I Kings last time?

→ READ & VIEW

1. OT Today p.383-385 (Ecclesiastes section)
2. ∞ Video Link: Ecclesiastes

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Ecclesiastes 1-2



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WEEK 8 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 32

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ INTRO

This is the story of Pandita Ramabai who was born in India in 1858. She tells the story of her childhood, her hardships, and coming to faith in Christ. She also translated the Bible into Marathi so the uneducated women of lower castes could read the Bible. She has a remarkable story of how the light of the gospel found her in the darkest places.

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Photo of Pandita and her daughter

→ BACKGROUND

India's caste system divides Hindus into four main categories—Brahmins, Kshatriyas, Vaishyas, and the Shudras. Many believe that the groups originated from Brahma, the Hindu God of creation. At the top of the hierarchy were the Brahmins, who were mainly teachers and intellectuals and believed to have come from Brahma's head. Then came the Kshatriyas, or the warriors and rulers, supposedly from his arms. The third slot went to the Vaishyas, or the traders, who were created from his thighs. At the bottom of the heap were the Shudras, who came from Brahma's feet and did all the menial jobs. The main castes were further divided into about 3,000 castes and 25,000 sub-castes, each based on their specific occupation.

Outside of this Hindu caste system were the achhoots—the Dalits or the untouchables. (from bbc.com)

Pandita's family was part of the Shudra caste—the one at the bottom that did the menial jobs.

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: Basics of Hinduism

→ LOCATE

Find the Western Ghats. They are a mountain range that stretches 1000 miles along the coast of India. This is where Pandita was born.

∞ Map Link: Map of India

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

An Honorable Heritage p.1-6

→ BACKGROUND

The doctrine of karma is the backbone of the religious and social system of Hinduism. Karma says that whatever someone has—whether physical appearance, financial status, personality, health, or sorrow—is a result of his past life. One goes through the cycle of reincarnation based on his dharma in a previous life. If someone gives himself to vice and moral degeneration, he will not be destroyed or cease to exist. Rather, he will continue in the cycle of reincarnation—as long as necessary—until his soul reaches nirvana and he becomes one with the Ultimate Reality. If someone lives a life of bad dharma, he will be reborn in a lower caste or as a lower life form in the next cycle. (from Ligonier Ministries)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

A Unique Education; Famine, Death and Doubts p.7-19

- How had the beliefs of Hinduism negatively impacted Pandita and her family?

• DEFINITIONS

Sanskrit: the sacred language of Hinduism

Vedas: a collection of poems or hymns composed in archaic Sanskrit that tell about Hindu teachings

Puranic literature: a vast genre of Hindu literature that includes a wide range of topics, especially legends and other traditional lore

Pandit: a teacher of any field of knowledge in Hinduism

penance: atonement for intentional and unintentional misdeeds



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WEEK 8 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 32

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.6 p.97-110

- Did you notice C.H. Spurgeon's quote about books in today's reading? What have you learned about Spurgeon that would show he agrees with the author's main point of the book, which is that the gospel changes everything in life? How did Spurgeon himself live out a life that would support that point?

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer question #1 on p.110 (because Spurgeon!) and choose either question 2 or 3 on p.111 to answer in your notebook.

WEEK 9 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 65

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Ecclesiastes last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1.Ecclesiastes 3-4

2.OT Today p.394-397 "A beautiful expensive" - "pretending its enough." (Skip inset on p.396)

WEEK 9 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Paul in Rome

Materials: ESV Concise Study Bible, Notebook

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about the Book of Acts?

→ INTRO

"God is at work getting his servant, Paul, to Rome where he will share the good news of Jesus" (Bible Story Handbook).

→ READ & NARRATE

1. Acts 28

2. (Optional) Read the notes in the ESV Concise Study Bible.

- How has the gospel message gone into the world over the events of the book of Acts?

WEEK 9 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 66

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Ecclesiastes last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1.Ecclesiastes 5-6

2.OT Today p.398-399 "The problem is" - "is heaven's business."



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WEEK 9 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 33

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ RECAP

Briefly recap what you read last time.

→ BACKGROUND

During the Vedic Period of northern India, the cow was a symbol of wealth and prosperity, as well as one of the animals offered in ritual religious sacrifices. But over time, possibly through the influence of Buddhism and Jainism, animal sacrifices waned, and the cow emerged as a sacred symbol to Hindus. The five products of the cow—milk, curds, butter, urine, and dung—are used in purifying and healing rituals. One popular Hindu god, Krishna, spent his early life as a cowherd, further elevating the status of the cow. In some states of India, there are bans and strict regulations concerning the slaughter of cows and the eating of beef. Many rules concerning food govern a Hindu's life—when to eat, what to eat, and who can prepare food for whom. The preparation and consumption of food are central to a Hindu's notion of ritual purity and, ultimately, their liberation from rebirth. Not all Hindus are vegetarians, but vegetarianism is seen as an indicator of purity. Many high-caste Hindus are vegetarians. (from International Mission Board)

→ LOCATE

Find Kolkata (formerly Calcutta). It is in the eastern part of India.
∞ Map Link: Map of India

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Introduction to Christianity; Calcutta; Marriage and Life in Bengal; Widowhood and Poona p.21-42

- Describe some of the inconsistencies Pandita was noticing about Hinduism and the Brahmo religion.

• DEFINITIONS

sahib: term used by some people in India to address or refer to a man in a position of authority. Sahib was used especially for government officials during the period of British rule.

amalgamate: merge into a single body

Upanishads: the most recent addition to the Vedas

Bengali: second-most spoken language in India

WEEK 9 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 33

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

Ch.7 p.113-126

→ NOTEBOOK

Choose two of the questions on p.127 to consider and answer in your notebook.

WEEK 10 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 67

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Ecclesiastes last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Ecclesiastes 7-8



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WEEK 10 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Review

Materials: Introducing the New Testament, Notebook

→ READ

1. Read Overview of Acts and recall everything you read about this year. p.206-209
2. Read Box 10.7 Church of Joy p. 226. What does it mean to have joy, and why is that an important characteristic for Christians?
3. Read Conclusion p.228-229.

→ NOTEBOOK

Look at the different themes in your notebook. Which theme(s) has the most events associated with it?

→ VIEW

Watch this video about the last chapters of the book of Acts.
∞ Video Link: Bound for Rome: Acts 21-28

- How did the gospel reach you and your family? How are you continuing to spread it to others?

WEEK 10 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 68

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Ecclesiastes last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

Ecclesiastes 9-11

WEEK 10 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 34

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ RECAP

Briefly recap what you read last time.

→ BACKGROUND

In the middle of the 19th century, a spiritual revival known as the Oxford Movement began in the Church of England. Those involved came to be known as Anglo-Catholics whose aim was to recall the Church of England to its origins and to restore reverence and beauty in worship. Out of the Oxford Movement came the first religious orders to be founded since Henry VIII of England dissolved the monasteries in 1536. The Community of St Mary the Virgin was one of the first religious orders founded at this time in 1848, in Wantage, England. A religious order consists of members who lead a contemplative lifestyle devoted to prayer and service. There were branches in India, which is where Pandita first met them.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

England: Being Drawn to the Religion of Christ, Finding Christ p.43-68

- What were some of the differences between Hinduism and Christianity that initially drew Pandita to accept Christianity?
- Why do you think she still felt like something was missing when she first believed the doctrines of Christianity?
- How did everything change for her when she came to know Christ personally as her Lord and Savior?

• DEFINITIONS

Svarga: a set of celestial worlds where the Hindu deities live and those who have led righteous lives can delight in pleasures, before their next birth on earth

• EXTRA HELPING

Read about the beliefs of Hinduism and how it differs from Christianity.

∞ **Article Link:** What is Hinduism?



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WEEK 10 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 34

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.129-138 "Throughout this book" - "and love them."

→ READ

∞ Article Link: William Wilberforce and His Circle of Friends
Beginning at the fourth paragraph (which begins with "Throughout history"), read the linked article to learn about William Wilberforce's group of friends who supported his efforts and encouraged him as a community around him. This reading can be split between this and next week if needed.

- How does the description of the group of friends around Wilberforce align with what has been presented in this book as far as how the gospel affects our relationships is concerned? How did these friends encourage each other in their spiritual lives?

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer question #2 on p.146 in your notebook. Write out a prayer asking the Lord to help you in your relationships with others, whether that is a friend, a parent, a sibling, or someone else.

WEEK 11 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 69

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading in Ecclesiastes last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. Ecclesiastes 12
2. I Kings 11
3. 12th Graders: Song of Solomon 1-4

WEEK 11 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Catch Up

→ CATCH UP

Use this time to catch up on lessons in this or another course, or explore Extra Helpings.

• EXTRA HELPING

You may be interested in watching this movie on the Book of Acts. They use the exact words of the Bible.

∞ Video Link: Movie on the Book of Acts

WEEK 11 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 70

Materials: Bible, OT Today, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about your reading last time?

→ READ, NARRATE, & RESPOND

1. 2 Chronicles 1-2
2. 12th Graders: Song of Solomon 5-8



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WEEK 11 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 35

Materials: An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words

→ RECAP

Briefly recap what you read last time.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Telling Others, Bombay, Glorious New Hope, Unexpected Visit from the Governor, A Loving Invitation p.69-106

- Why do you think it would be hard for Hindus to become Christians?
- What part of Pandita's message in these chapters has stood out to you?

• EXTRA HELPING

Check out the Operation World website to learn how you can pray for the people of India.

∞ Link: India-Operation World

WEEK 11 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 35

Materials: This Changes Everything, notebook

→ RECAP

What do you recall about what you read last time?

→ READ & NARRATE

p.138-148 "Siblings are a" - "live like it."

→ NOTEBOOK

Answer questions #1 and #3 on p.145-146 in your notebook. Write down any final thoughts about this book.

WEEK 12 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 71

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

WEEK 12 30m New Testament: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Acts

WEEK 12 30m Old Testament: Grades 7-12 - Lesson 72

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

WEEK 12 30m Church History: Grades 7-9 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words



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WEEK 12 30m Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: This Changes Everything



Bible: Grades 7-8

Examination

Term 1

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

- What are some of the observations or insights you gained from reading Old Testament Today or watching the videos?
- Tell about the events in Israelite history you read about this term and what we learn about the character of God.

New Testament: Grades 7-8

- Tell the story of the early church and how it grew.
- Tell about Peter and a few of the experiences that happened to him as he helped start the early church.

Church History: Grades 7-9

- Renewal: The Church that Expands Outward: Tell all you know about a person from church history that you read about this term and how their life and mission impacted others.

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

- Transformed by Truth: Explain how the Bible is a "Big Story." What elements of story do we see in the Bible? Give examples of those elements from the Bible story. OR Give two of the reasons the Bible should be studied, along with explanations of those reasons.

Term 2

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

- What are some of the observations or insights you gained from reading Old Testament Today or watching the videos?
- Tell about any insights you learned from the Psalms or the kinds of Psalms that make up the Psalter. OR Tell about the events that happened in Israelite history and what they show about the character of God.

New Testament: Grades 7-8

- Tell about Paul's first missionary journey.
- Name three people who helped support Paul in his ministry in your reading this term.

Church History: Grades 7-9

- Spurgeon: A Biography: Tell about what you have learned of Charles Spurgeon's life and ministry over this term of reading.

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

- Transformed by Truth: What are the three steps of inductive Bible study? Explain what each step involves. OR How would you go about studying a chapter of the Bible?

Term 3

Old Testament: Grades 7-12

- What are some of the observations or insights you gained from reading Old Testament Today or watching the videos?
- Tell what you learned about the wisdom literature of Proverbs and Ecclesiastes.

New Testament: Grades 7-8

- What do you remember about Paul's third missionary journey?
- What are some hardships Paul faced on his journeys? How did Paul respond to these trials?

Church History: Grades 7-9

- An Honorable Heritage: The Pandita Ramabai Story in Her Own Words: Tell all you know about Pandita's journey from being born into a Hindu family to later becoming a Christian. How did her beliefs and life change when she put her faith in Christ?

Spiritual Formation: Grades 7-8

- This Changes Everything: How has the author supported her point that "why who we are influences what we do"? Name two areas the gospel affects in our lives, and how what we do changes in those areas because of who we are in Christ. OR In what ways does the gospel affect how we relate to the church? What are some ways the author states a believer is called to support the church?